China by bypassing proper procedures. But the new Nepalese government under Oli has promised to revive this project for China.[26]

India has also expedited its pending projects in Sri Lanka, where it has sought projects on or closer to the sites of Chinese projects. This may help India monitor Chinese activities closely and also give China a sense of competition. India's interest in the Eastern Container Terminal at the Colombo Port where China is raising the "Port City Project" may be recalled here. President Sirisena was, however, not sympathetic to this Indian proposal and instead preferred that India undertake the West Container Terminal, which has to be built from scratch. India's collaboration with Japan on the Colombo Port project has softened Sri Lanka's resistance. But, as noted earlier, India is still keenly awaiting Sri Lanka's acceptance of its interests in Trincomalee, Mattala, and Colombo projects.[27] The previous Sri Lankan government was keen to renegotiate some Chinese projects in order to ease its debt burden. China was not prepared to alter its basic terms and eventually persuaded Sri Lanka to grant these projects like Hambantota to China on equity basis (85 percent) for a 99-year lease. This has strengthened China's economic presence in Sri Lanka, though Sri Lanka has made sure that control over the Hambantota project will remain with the Sri Lankan Navy. Reiterating this while addressing the Third Asia Europe Political Forum in Colombo in April 2019, then Sri Lankan Prime Minister Ranil Wickremesinghe said:

> Many people consider (that the) Hambantota port as a Chinese military base. I accept that there will be a military camp. But it is a Sri Lankan Navy camp. Once installed, a Sri Lankan Rear Admiral will be in control. Any ship from any country can come there. But we control the